

CRANE BANKSMAN AND COMMUNICATION

Control communication failure, blind-lift and load-movement hazards.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Ensure safe communication between the crane operator, banksman and lifting team, and prevent collision, crushing and dropped-load hazards caused by blind lifts, conflicting signals, swing-radius exposure and communication failure. Only the designated and competent banksman should direct the operator. Conflicting instructions from several people can lead to uncontrolled load movement.

KEY HAZARDS

1  WRONG SIGNAL	2  LOST SIGHT	3  LOST COMMUNICATION	4  SUSPENDED LOAD
5  CRUSHING	6  SWING	7  BLIND SPOT	8  MULTIPLE COMMANDS

CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

1 person

Signal person giving standard commands

100%

Continuous sight or backup communication

STOP

Emergency signal anyone may give



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA 1926.1416, .1422 and .1428 govern when signals are required, standard signals, loss of communication and signal-person qualification.

OSHA 1926.1416

WHEN SIGNALS ARE REQUIRED

Use a signal person when the operator cannot fully see the point of operation or site conditions require one.

OSHA 1926.1422

STANDARD SIGNALS

Use applicable standard hand signals and agree any non-standard signals before the lift.

OSHA 1926.1416(c)

LOSS OF COMMUNICATION

If communication is interrupted, the operator must stop movement until the load and equipment are safely controlled.

OSHA 1926.1428

QUALIFICATION

The signal person must know and demonstrate signals and be qualified through practical and oral/written assessment.

MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Signal-person qualification record | ☐ Lifting plan |
| ☐ Signal-method briefing | ☐ Radio channel / call test |
| ☐ Line-of-sight check | ☐ Exclusion-zone control |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Who is the appointed banksman today?
- Have the hand signals been confirmed?
- Which radio channel and backup method will be used?

STANDARD HAND SIGNAL AND LOAD CONTROL



One signal person - Line of sight - Standard signal - Tag line - Exclusion zone



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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. PLAN LINE OF SIGHT

Appoint one competent banksman. Confirm standard signals before starting.

2. DESIGNATE ONE SIGNAL PERSON

Use reliable radio communication for blind lifts. Stop the lift immediately if communication is lost. Position the banksman with clear visibility.

3. USE STANDARD SIGNALS

Barricade the crane swing radius. Keep personnel clear of suspended loads. Explain the emergency-stop signal to the team.

4. STOP IF COMMUNICATION FAILS

Monitor wind and visibility conditions. Inform the operator and team if the banksman changes.

CRITICAL WARNING



If the operator cannot see the banksman or communication is lost, the lift must stop. Do not move when in doubt.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Banksman competent | ☐ Single signalman appointed |
| ☐ Signals confirmed | ☐ Radio working |
| ☐ Backup communication ready | ☐ Swing area barricaded |
| ☐ Load path clear | ☐ Visibility suitable |
| ☐ Wind acceptable | |



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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			